



**TEAM SUPERSABJI**  
**ADITYA KHARI BCH/129**  
**SARTHAK SINHA BCP/299**  
**AAKSHAT PATHAK BCH/102**



# EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

THE ULTIMATE FRESHERS CASE COMP

## VANTAGE

## BACKGROUND

### VALUE-CHAIN MODEL



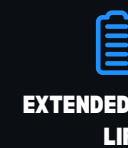
Stark industries is a 3-year old Direct-to-consumer (D2C) wearable tech fitness watch brand known for it's 'IronPulse' series under which they manufacture three categories of watches 1) Sport 2) Pro 3) Elite. The brand offers heart-rate and SpO2 sensing, GPS, sleep tracking, and personalised training and recovery insights through the IronSync app which converts the data into a detailed report through AI. With a target audience of 18-30 year olds the brand promises to deliver quality, precision and a brand with a loyal customer base acquired mainly through it's social media handles.



IRONPULSE  
SPORT



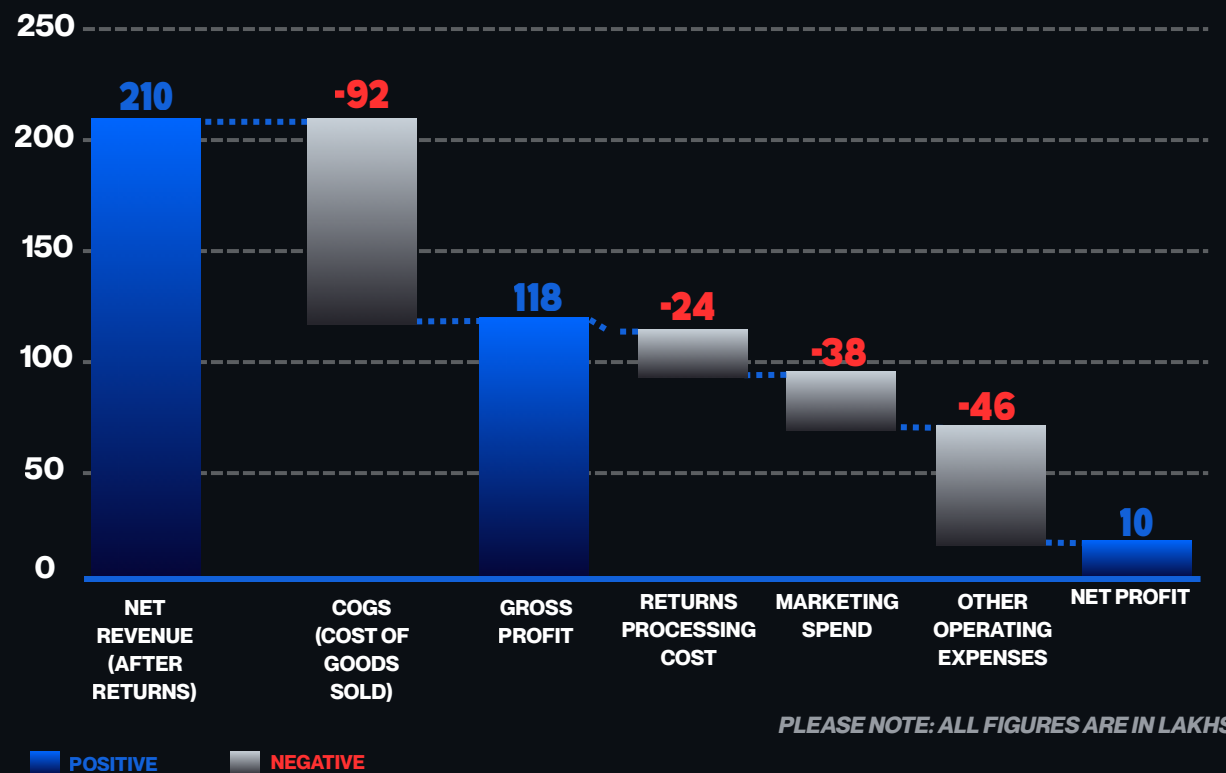
IRONPULSE  
PRO



IRONPULSE  
ELITE



### FINANCIAL ANALYSIS (PREVIOUS QUARTER)



GROSS MARGIN  
56.2%  
(₹118/ ₹210 LAKHS)

RETURN COST IMPACT  
11.4%  
₹24/ ₹210 LAKHS

NET MARGIN  
4.8%  
(₹10/ ₹210 LAKHS)

### PROBLEM STATEMENT

Stark Industries is facing an elevated return rate of 28%, primarily driven by customers selecting incorrect smartwatch band sizes, which results in poor sensor contact, inaccurate biometric readings, and a disappointing user experience.

| Model           | % of Total Revenue<br><small>Share of total net revenue (after returns)</small> | Return Rate<br><small>Returns as a % of units sold for the model</small> | Insights<br><small>Indications</small>                          |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| IRONPULSE SPORT | 45%                                                                             | 18%                                                                      | Strong revenue driver with relatively lower return rate         |
| IRONPULSE PRO   | 30%                                                                             | 42%                                                                      | Highest return rate indicating major quality/fit issues         |
| IRONPULSE ELITE | 25%                                                                             | 24%                                                                      | Moderate return rate; mainly driven by comfort expectation gaps |

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Proposed Model

Festive Campaign

Industrial Analysis

Appendix



Please Note: While each solution addresses a specific model, all recommended enhancements can be integrated across the entire IronPulse series as per the requirement.

ADAPTS TO YOU

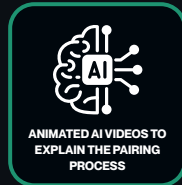
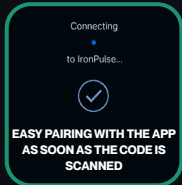
SOLUTION 1



SMART QR SETUP

FOR IRONPULSE SPORTS

- Unique QR card with every watch
- One-scan pairing & location tracking
- Guided pairing & calibration
- Additional guided AI animated videos for pairing



SOLUTION 2



FITSENSE TECHNOLOGY

FOR IRONPULSE PRO

- Enter wrist size in
- App recommends size accordingly
- Stretchable metal bands in 3 sizes (S/M/L)
- Braided metal stretchable bands which stretch upto 6 inches and fit different wrist sizes



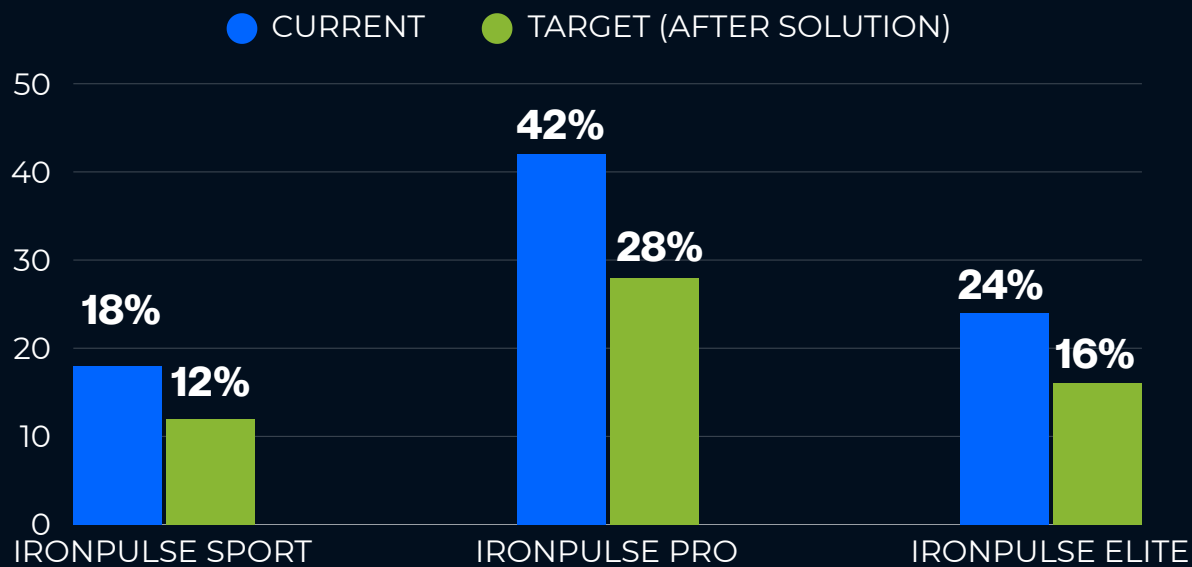
SOLUTION 3



COMFORT SOLUTION

FOR IRONPULSE ELITE

- Silicon sensor cushion for no discomfort on wrist
- Gel-padding in leather strap
- 360 degree product visuals
- More designs and personalised strap printing



ESTIMATED FINANCIALS

RETURN COST IMPACT

| CURRENT | TARGET |
|---------|--------|
| 11.4%   | 7-8%   |

NET REVENUE

| CURRENT | TARGET     |
|---------|------------|
| ₹210 L  | ₹220-235 L |

GROSS MARGIN

| CURRENT | TARGET |
|---------|--------|
| 56.2%   | 55.8%  |

NET MARGIN

| CURRENT | TARGET |
|---------|--------|
| 4.8%    | 8-10%  |

RETURN COST SAVINGS

| CURRENT | TARGET  |
|---------|---------|
| ₹24 L   | ₹7-10 L |

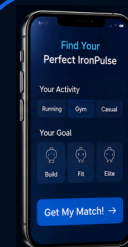
CUSTOMER SATISFACTION

★★★★★  
EXPECTED INCREASE

REAL USER CONTENT & IRONPULSE COMMUNITY



- Genuine reviews
- Building a stronger and loyal customer base through in-app community
- Competitions, Marathons and activity sessions



APP PERSONALISATION & AI MENTOR

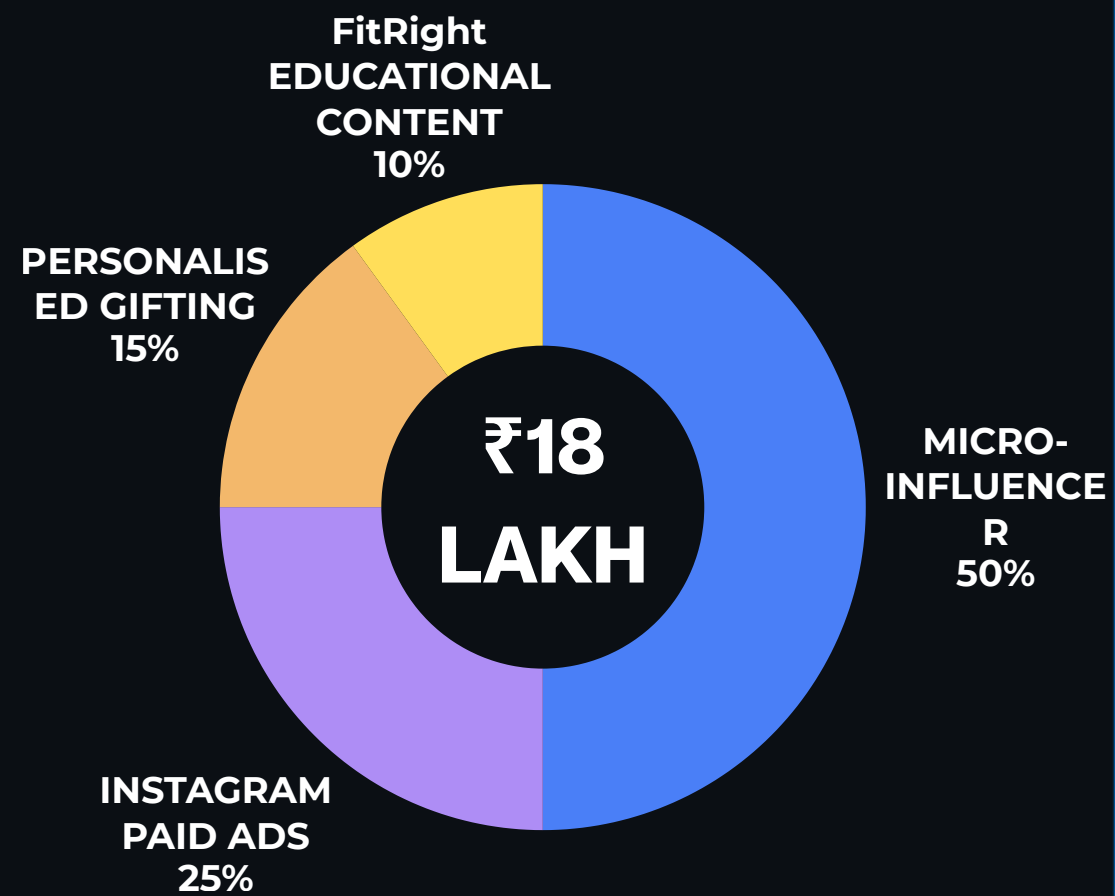
- Personalised fitness programmes
- AI Mentor for workout sessions and calorie count
- Continuous progress tracking with smart goals and performance optimization.



IRONPULSE AMBASSADOR PROGRAM

- Earn rewards and exclusive benefits after every activity.
- Access to member-only offers and exclusive fitness events.
- Redeemable rewards for vouchers

### BUDGET DISTRIBUTION (₹18 LAKHS)



### RAKHI

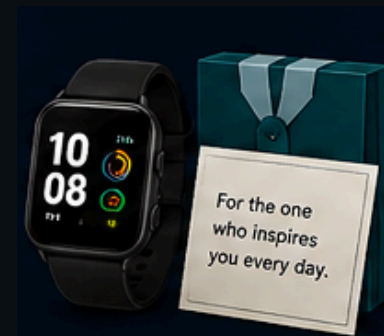
A PROMISE BEYOND PROTECTION



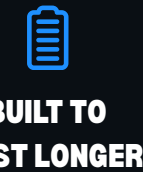
Gift them a promise that cares for their health, everyday



### Made for their wrist



Personalisation and custom gift cards with premium festive packaging



### FIT TOGETHER CHALLENGE



More watches, more family time



### DIWALI



A gift that delivers value every single day



TECHNOLOGY THAT HELPS YOU BIND TOGETHER

### EXPECTED IMPACT

#### WHY THIS BUDGET SPLIT?



Influencers build trust & drive buyers in short time



Instagram ads maximize reach



Personalisation adds gifting appeal



Educational content like family fitness campaigns

#### OVERALL RETURN RATE

CURRENT  
**28%**

TARGET  
**18-20%**

#### CUSTOMER ACQUISITION COST

CURRENT  
**₹580**

TARGET

**₹460-480**

#### REPEAT PURCHASE RATE

CURRENT  
**BASELINE**

TARGET

**+15%**

#### REPEAT PURCHASE RATE

CURRENT  
**₹24 L**

TARGET

**₹7-10 L**





# INDUSTRIAL ANALYSIS

Understanding the market, competition and why returns occur

THE ULTIMATE FRESHERS CASE COMP

VANTAGE

## 1 MARKET ANALYSIS - INDIAN WATCH MARKET

India's smartwatch market is correcting after years of hyper-growth. The sales volume is low, however consumers are moving towards better quality products



“ Consumers are prioritising better sensors, longer battery life and accurate health tracking

Source: Counterpoint, Omdia, Techinsights (2025-26)

## 2 ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS - WHY RETURNS HAPPEN



### PAIRING ISSUES

Complex pairing, permission issues & app instabilities

#1 Reason for returns



### FIT/SIZING ISSUES

Incorrect band size, loose or tight fit, comfort mismatch

#2 Reason for returns



### SENSOR ACCURACY PROBLEMS

Mismatch or inconsistent readings & data sync issues

#3 Reason for returns



### BATTERY-LIFE ISSUES

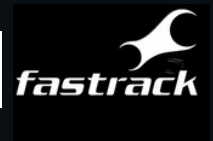
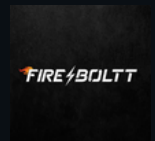
Battery drains out faster, power reduces faster as the device gets older

#4 Reason for returns

“ Reliability gaps across connectivity, fit, sensor performance, and battery life remain the primary drivers of smartwatch returns.

Source: Ken Research – India Fitness Tracker Market Size

## 3 COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

|                           | KEY PLAYERS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | STRENGTH                                                                | KEY LIMITATIONS                                                           |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PREMIUM<br>(₹15K+)        |  <br> | Best-in-class accuracy, ecosystem depth, brand trust, premium materials | High price, closed or less open ecosystems, limited India volume for some |
| MID-PREMIUM<br>(₹5K-15K)  |                                                                                          | Good features, global experience, growing brand equity                  | Differentiation gaps, inconsistent fit experience                         |
| BUDGET FRIENDLY<br>(₹<5K) |  <br> | Strong distribution, aggressive pricing, youth appeal                   | Low sensor accuracy, high returns, price wars                             |

## PORTER'S 5 FORCES OF BUSINESS VIABILITY



### 01 THREAT OF NEW ENTRANTS

Medium: Manufacturing barriers are relatively low due to OEM partnerships, but building brand credibility, distribution networks, and customer trust remains challenging.

### 02 BUYER POWER

High: Consumers have numerous alternatives and can easily compare products online. Strong performance, reliability, and brand trust significantly influence purchasing decisions and retention.

### 03 THREAT OF SUBSTITUTES

Medium-High: Fitness bands, smartphones, and traditional watches continue to serve similar consumer needs. Smartwatches must deliver clear health, convenience, and lifestyle benefits to justify adoption.

### 04 SUPPLIER POWER

Medium: While smartwatch brands depend on specialized sensor, chipset, and battery suppliers, the availability of multiple sourcing partners helps limit supplier dominance.

### 05 COMPETITIVE RIVALRY

High: The smartwatch market is intensely competitive, with established brands competing on price, features, and marketing. Differentiation through product quality and user experience is becoming increasingly important.

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# APPENDIX (SURVEY ANALYSIS)



## SAMPLE SIZE

70 Respondents



## TARGET AUDIENCE

Smartwatch Users & Potential Buyers



## LOCATION

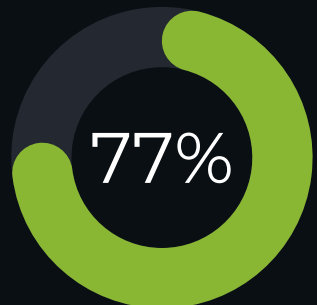
India (Primarily Delhi-NCR)



## SURVEY METHOD

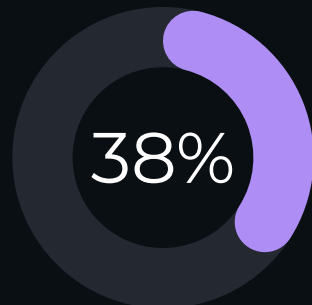
Online Survey (Google Forms)

### 1. NEED FOR A SIZING GUIDE



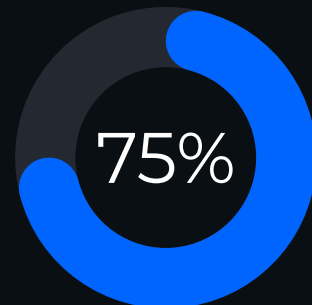
of respondents would prefer a wrist-measurement guide before purchasing a smartwatch.

### 2. FIT-RELATED RETURNS



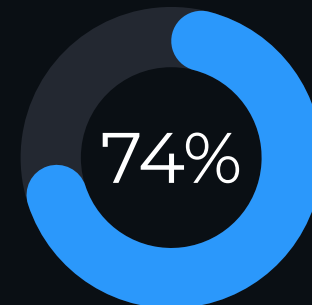
have returned or considered returning a smartwatch due to fit-related issues

### 3. IMPORTANCE OF SENSOR ACCURACY



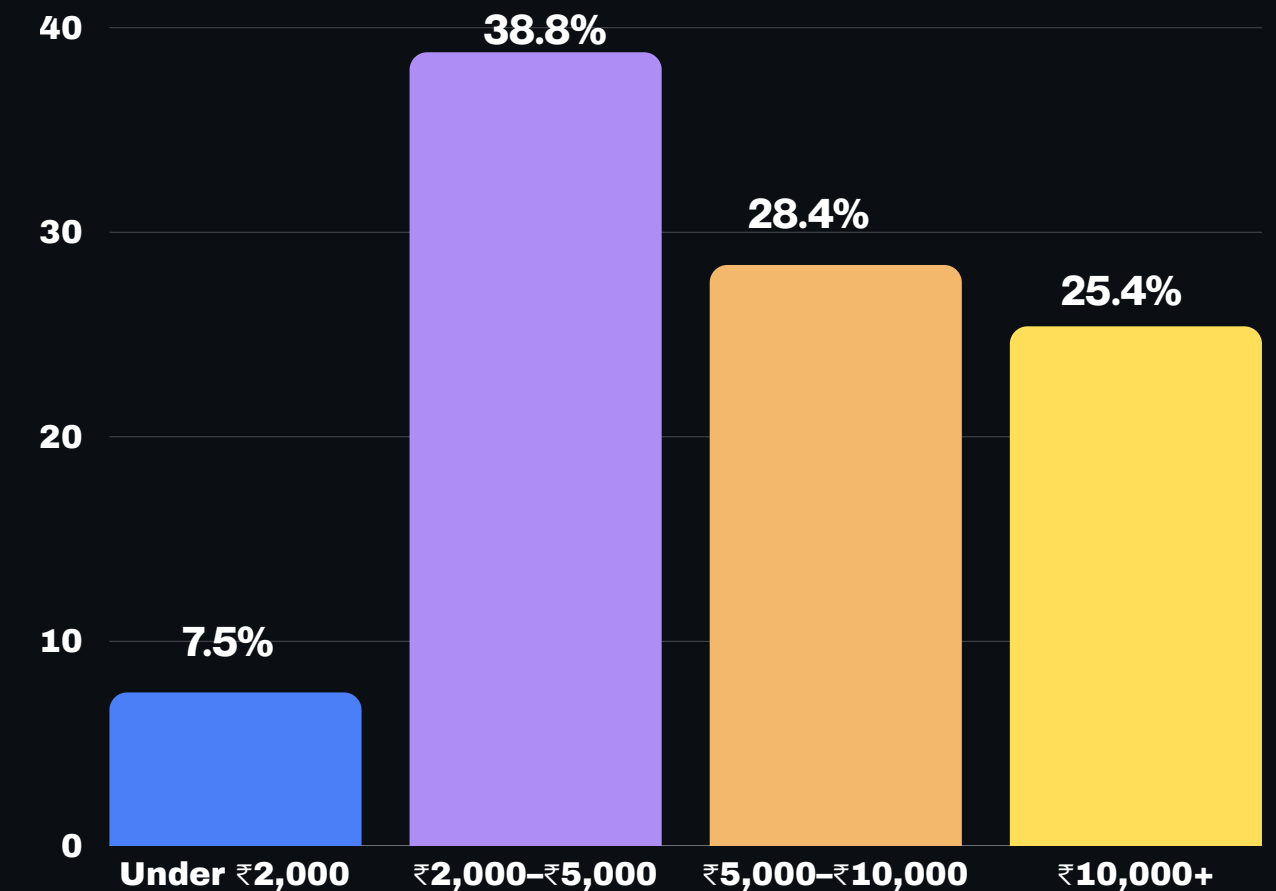
are aware that loose-fitting bands negatively affect heart-rate and SpO2 accuracy.

### 4. WILLINGNESS TO PAY MORE



would pay a premium for guaranteed fit and verified sensor accuracy.

### PRICE PREFERENCE





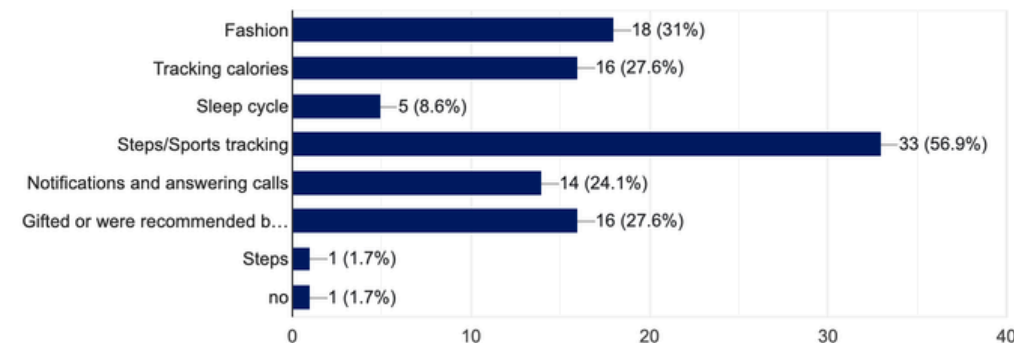
**FORM LINK-** <https://forms.gle/BVjiB5euUjaERxa88>

**RESPONSE LINK-**

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1wrSYDEOPINgyaz3Bj1TzDAQG0auhrN8GORCzZg3DrbM/edit?usp=sharing>

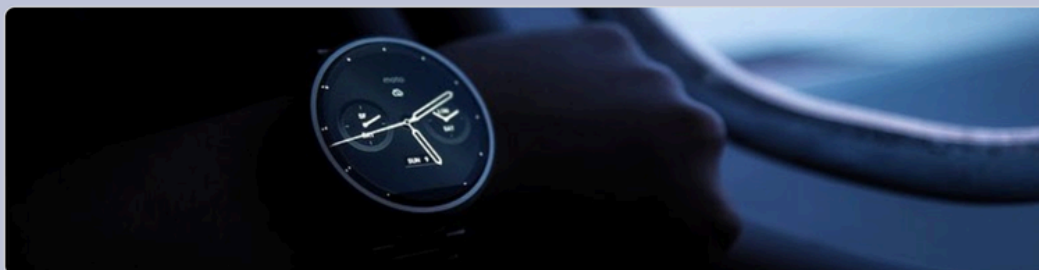
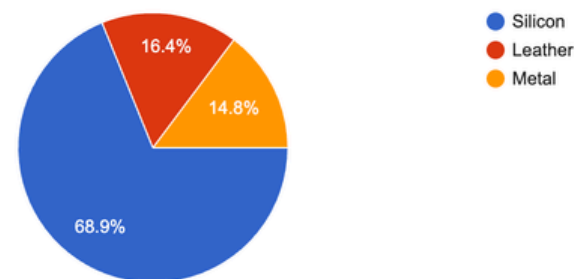
What's your main reason for owning a smartwatch?

58 responses



What material strap do you prefer in a smartwatch?

61 responses



Section 1 of 3

### The Perfect Fit Survey

Form description

Name \*

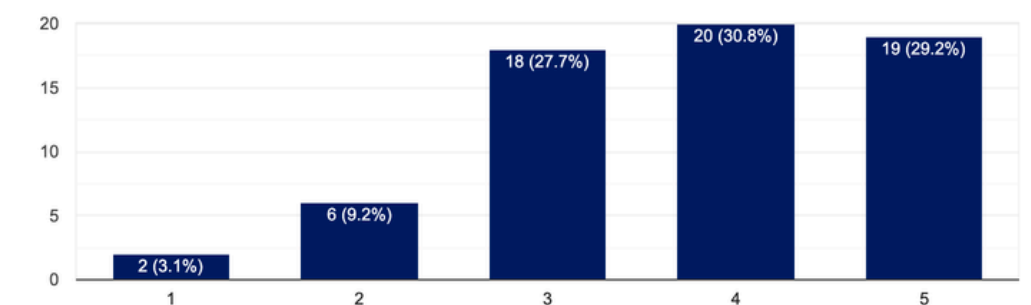
Short answer text

Age group \*

- ☐ 18-20
- ☐ 21-24
- ☐ 25-27

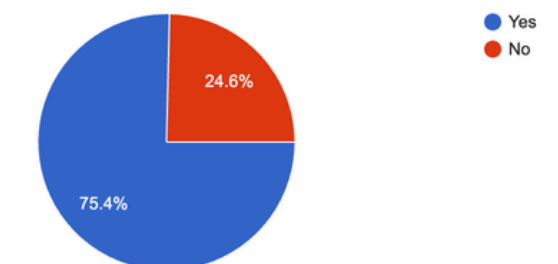
How important is heart rate/SpO2 accuracy to you when choosing a smartwatch? on a scale of 1-5 (1=lowest, 5=highest)

65 responses



Were you aware that a loose-fitting band can cause inaccurate heart rate/SpO2 readings?

65 responses



## Secondary Research Sources

Industry reports, competitor websites, e-commerce platforms, and online communities used to validate findings.

### 1. Statista

S

Market Sizing & Industry Trends

### 2. Counterpoint Research

C

Smartwatch Market Share

### 3. IDC

I

Wearables Industry Reports

### 4. Deloitte

D

Consumer Behavior Insights

### 5. McKinsey & Company

M

Premiumization Trends

### 6. Titan Official Website

T

Competitor Benchmarking

### 7. Noise Official Website

N

Product & Pricing Analysis

### 8. boAt Official Website

b

Product Portfolio Analysis

### 9. Fire-Boltt Official Website

F

Competitor Pricing

### 10. Fastrack Official Website

F

Brand Positioning

### 11. Amazon India

A

Product Reviews & Pricing

### 12. Flipkart

F

Consumer Ratings & Pricing



### HOW THE SMARTWATCH MARKET COMPETES

#### BUDGET FEATURE RACE

Noise . boAt . Fire-Boltt

Competes on price, display size and raw feature count. Saturated; the segment driving the shipment decline.

#### FITNESS-DATA SPECIALISTS

Garmin . Amazfit

Competes on training metrics, battery life and sports ecosystems for serious athletes.

#### PREMIUM ECOSYSTEMS

Apple . Samsung

Competes on health credibility, device integration and brand trust — the fastest-growing tier.

*IronPulse sits between specialist and premium — real biometrics, D2C price — but only if the fit that makes sensors accurate is solved.*

### THE WHITE SPACE: FIT-VERIFIED WEARABLES

**Every competitor sells a sensor. None of them sell certainty that it's reading correctly on your wrist. IronPulse can own that moment.**

This is also IronPulse's own problem, at industry scale:

|                                        |        |
|----------------------------------------|--------|
| Healthy online-wearable return band    | 12-18% |
| Stark Industries blended return rate   | 28%    |
| IronPulse Pro (metal band) return rate | 42%    |

*Whoever solves fit-confidence first converts the industry's premiumization trend into share — instead of losing volume to it.*